

Chicago Tribune



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BREAKING NEWS AT CHICAGOTRIBUNE.COM

Trump proposes US control Gaza

Suggestion likely to roil next stage of truce negotiations

By Aamer Madhani, Tia Goldenberg and Zeke Miller
Associated Press

WASHINGTON — President Donald Trump on Tuesday suggested that displaced Palestinians in Gaza be “permanently” resettled outside the war-torn territory and proposed the U.S. take “ownership” in redeveloping

the war-torn territory. Trump’s audacious proposal appears certain to roil the next stage of talks meant to extend the tenuous ceasefire between Israel and Hamas and secure the release of the remaining hostages held in Gaza. The provocative comments came as talks are ramping up this week with the promise of surging humanitarian aid and reconstruc-

tion supplies to help the people of Gaza recover after more than 15 months of devastating conflict. Now Trump wants to push roughly 1.8 million people to leave the land they have called home and claim it for the U.S., perhaps with American troops. Trump outlined his thinking as he held talks with Israeli Prime Minister Benjamin Netanyahu at the White House, where the two

leaders also discussed the fragile ceasefire and hostage deal in the Israeli-Hamas conflict and shared concerns about Iran. “I don’t think people should be going back,” Trump said. “You can’t live in Gaza right now. I think we need another location. I think it should be a location that’s going to make people happy.” Trump said the U.S. would take ownership of the Gaza Strip and redevelop it after Palestinians are resettled elsewhere and turn the territory into “the Riviera of the

Middle East” in which the “world’s people” — including Palestinians — would live. “We’ll make sure that it’s done world class,” Trump said. “It’ll be wonderful for the people — Palestinians, Palestinians mostly, we’re talking about.” Egypt, Jordan and other U.S. allies in the Mideast have cautioned Trump that relocating Palestinians from Gaza would threaten Mideast stability, risk

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Public weighs in on justice, environment initiatives

Framework to help Cook County make ‘cohesive decisions’

By Adriana Pérez
Chicago Tribune

Several days after Tara Stamps was appointed as a Cook County board commissioner in the summer of 2023, heavy storms flooded homes in her district’s West Side neighborhoods — including her own. “So I wasn’t just a representative, I was a victim,” Stamps said at a Monday town hall focused on the county’s draft of its first-ever environmental justice policy. “My uncle who lives with me who’s a double amputee diabetic, was just on his bed, like a life raft, in the basement. And what’s so sad about that is, so many of the elders were like prisoners in their own homes during this time.”

While that was not the first significant flooding most long-time West Side residents experienced, she added, moving out or rehabbing homes can be expensive solutions — especially when outdated urban infrastructure that can’t withstand the intensity of climate-fueled storms continues creating “problem after problem.” After developing the draft, the Cook County Department of Environment and Sustainability has asked for public input to address gaps in community investment and support those historically overburdened by pollution and severe weather. Focus areas include air pollution, access to clean drinking water, flooding and infrastructure, climate resiliency, access to healthy food, transportation, access to green spaces and economic development. Dozens of community groups, activists and residents have shown up to town halls like the one Monday at Malcolm X College in Chicago; some have been held virtually and others in person in

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INSIDE



TERRENCE ANTONIO JAMES/TRIBUNE

Waves of creativity in Mexican seafood

Mariscos San Pedro, inside Thalia Hall in Pilsen, defies expectations with whimsical techniques from trio of chefs. **Food & Health**

Are area fans above booing foolishness?

Blackhawks fans can send a message by cheering — not booing — the Canadian national anthem. **Paul Sullivan in Chicago Sports**



Ald. Byron Sigcho-Lopez, 25th, walks out of council chambers after being told to leave during the Committee on Special Events meeting at Chicago City Hall on Tuesday. **EILEEN T. MESLAR/CHICAGO TRIBUNE PHOTOS**

Debate at council meeting nosedives into acrimony

Alderman told to leave after he appeared to call colleague a white supremacist

By Jake Sheridan
Chicago Tribune

A City Council debate over whether a controversial pro-Gaza puppet display at the Chicago Cultural Center is antisemitic or a fair expression of free speech descended into disorder Tuesday, with an aldermanic ally of Mayor Brandon Johnson being told to leave the council chambers after he appeared to call another alderman a “white supremacist.” Ald. Byron Sigcho-Lopez, 25th, who last year was criticized for speaking at a protest rally where an American flag was burned, later Tuesday claimed he said the words “this is white supremacist” in the direction of Ald. Bill Conway, 34th, and didn’t direct his comments to Conway individually. After the comment was made during a committee meeting, it was temporarily recessed and neither alderman returned. The committee chair said he told



Ald. Bill Conway, 34th, speaks during the Committee on Special Events meeting at City Hall on Tuesday.

Sigcho-Lopez not to return.

The argument capped a four-hour debate about the puppetry exhibit that features a two-sided “protest puppet” with bloodied caricatures of Uncle Sam and Israeli Prime Minister Benjamin Netanyahu. Writing on the

wooden bases holding up the puppet criticizes U.S. financial support for Israel’s war efforts in Gaza and labels the characters as “children killers” and “murderers.” As many as 28 aldermen, a majority of the City Coun-

cil, signed a letter last month condemning the puppet display as antisemitic “hate speech.” But some aldermen during the no-vote hearing criticized that condemnation as an attack on free speech and a waste of time. “Last time I checked, in America, we should be free to express ourselves,” said Ald. William Hall, 6th. Conway during the debate pressed Department of Cultural Affairs and Special Events Commissioner Clinée Hedspeth about the artwork before Sigcho-Lopez chimed in and the two aldermen began a heated back-and-forth during which Sigcho-Lopez said Conway had disrespected Hedspeth. Conway, who represents parts of the Loop, Greektown and Little Italy, had earlier in the debate referenced burning the American flag. Sigcho-Lopez, who represents parts of Pilsen

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WeatherTech on wild ride with 13th Super Bowl ad

Once-obscure Bolingbrook company on a remarkable run

By Robert Channick
Chicago Tribune

When Super Bowl LIX airs Sunday on Fox from New Orleans, more than 100 million viewers are expected to watch the Kansas City Chiefs vie for an unprecedented three-peat when they take on the Philadelphia Eagles.

An unlikely Chicago team is on an equally remarkable Super Bowl run, as WeatherTech, a once-obscure Bolingbrook car floor mat manufacturer, and Pinnacle Advertising, a small Schaumburg agency, roll out their 13th Super Bowl commercial since 2014. That WeatherTech is still going head-to-head with some of the biggest brands in the world — a true David-and-Goliath marketing story — has defied skeptics and arguably changed the game

of Super Bowl advertising. “It’s really been astonishing,” said Tim Calkins, a marketing professor at Northwestern University’s Kellogg School of Management who heads up an annual Super Bowl advertising review. “I keep thinking it will be their last year. They keep showing up.” In 2014, WeatherTech founder David MacNeil had the audacity to blow a large chunk of his marketing budget on his first Super Bowl spot, paying \$4

million for the airtime to compete on TV’s biggest advertising stage. Employing the creative chops of little-known northwest suburban ad agency Pinnacle made WeatherTech even more of a long shot to succeed. Despite the naysayers, WeatherTech has become a Super Bowl mainstay over the years, joining the likes of Budweiser, Doritos and T-Mobile. In the process, the privately owned company has

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